

50/30/20 Budget Planner 2026

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Why This Works

The 50/30/20 rule is the simplest way to take control of your money:

- 50% for Needs (rent, food, transport)
- 30% for Wants (entertainment, dining)
- 20% for Savings & Debt payoff

Step 1: Calculate Your Monthly Income

- Write your take-home pay (after tax)
- This is your base number for all allocations

Step 2: Set Your Needs Budget (50%)

- Housing: ...
- Groceries: ...
- Transport: ...
- Utilities: ...

Step 3: Set Your Wants Budget (30%)

- Dining out: ...
- Entertainment: ...
- Shopping: ...

Step 4: Automate Your Savings (20%)

- Move 20% to a separate account on payday
- Set up auto-transfer — you won't miss what you never see

Weekly Check-in

- Every Sunday: review what you spent
- Adjust categories that are over budget
- Celebrate small wins — consistency beats perfection

Debt Snowball Bonus

- List debts smallest to largest
- Attack the smallest while paying minimums on the rest
- Momentum builds as each debt disappears